

CS2 PdxModsCache Integrated Tool Distribution Manual (Full English Edition)

Target Version: v1.3

Purpose: Copy / Excel export / CSV export for PdxModsCache.json

Distribution Format: User guide intended for GitHub Releases
distribution

Author	IDW
Distribution	GitHub Releases page (replace with the actual public URL)
Intended Users	Users who want to organize Cities: Skylines II MOD management data
Recommended Package Contents	Main EXE, README, sample images if needed, and this manual

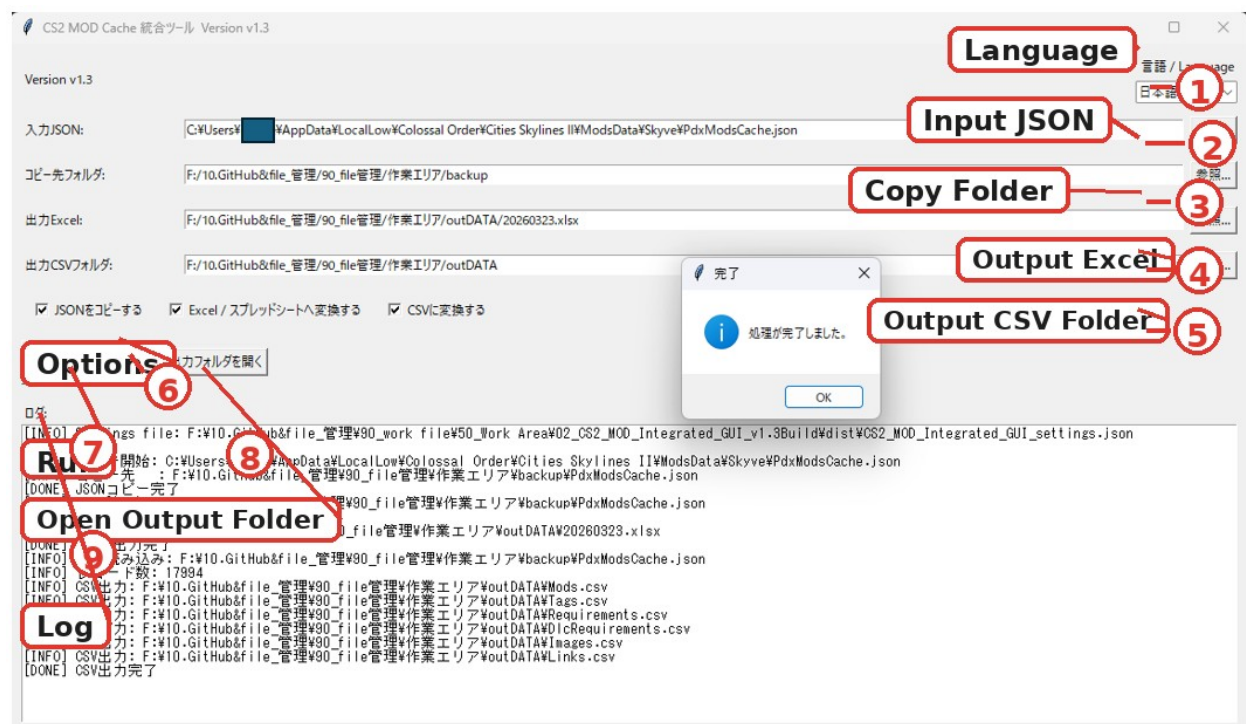


Figure 1. Full application screen (numbered guide)

1. How to use this manual

- This manual is easiest to follow in this order: key points → installation → screen guide → basic workflow → troubleshooting.
- Most users can start with the EXE package. The Python source version is mainly for development, testing, or review.

Key points

- For the EXE version, installation is usually not required. Just extract the ZIP and run the EXE.
- The input JSON should be Skyve's PdxModsCache.json.
- There are three main output destinations: backup folder, Excel file, and CSV folder.
- If an error occurs, first check the log area and the actual state of the output folders.

2. Tool overview

- Copy PdxModsCache.json safely to a backup location.
- Convert JSON content into a multi-sheet Excel workbook.
- Convert the same content into multiple CSV files.
- Save the previous input path, output paths, language, and checkbox states to settings.json.
- Support both Japanese and English UI switching.

3. Target file and storage location

The image below shows an example of where Skyve-managed JSON data may be found. The user name portion depends on the actual Windows environment.

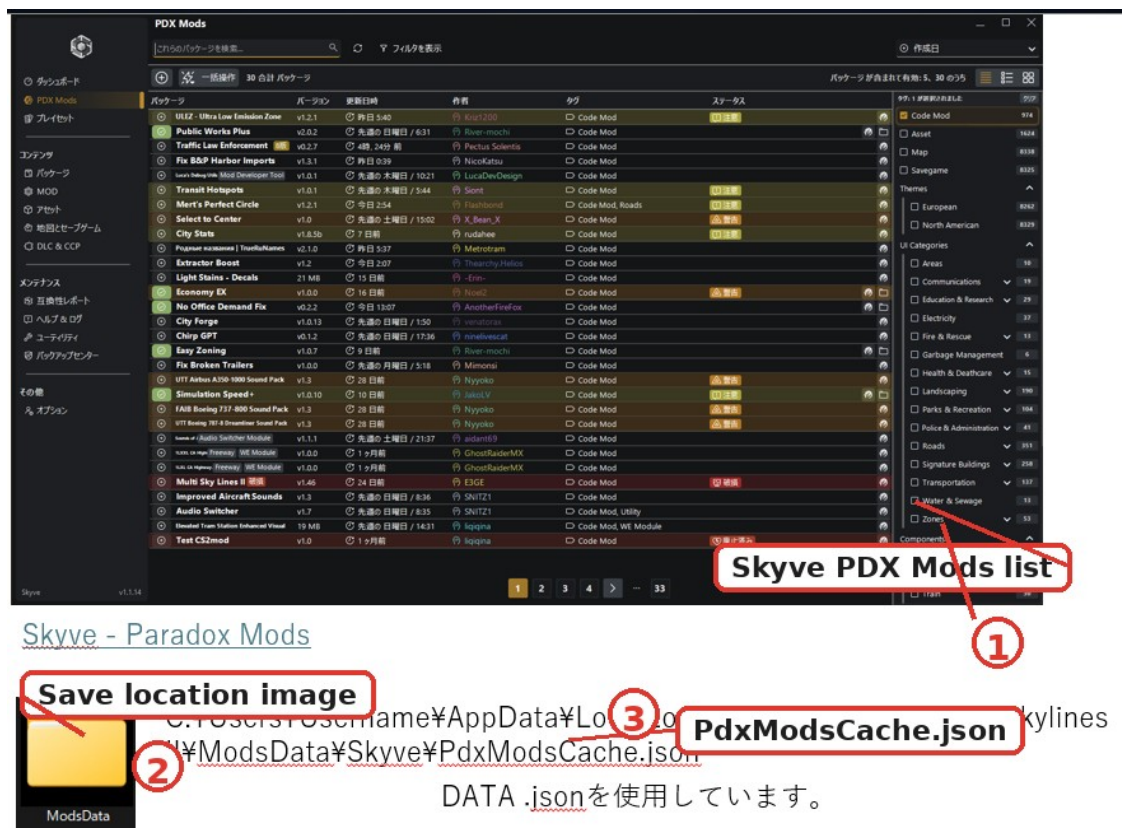


Figure 2. Example location of PdxModsCache.json used by Skyve

4. Installation

This tool can be used in two ways: the EXE package for distribution and the Python source version for development or verification.

4-1. EXE version (recommended for distribution)

- Download the ZIP file from GitHub Releases.
- Right-click the ZIP and choose Extract All.
- Run the EXE inside the extracted folder.
- If SmartScreen appears on first launch, verify the publisher information and the published hash value before proceeding.

Suggested package contents:

- CS2_MOD_Integrated_GUI.exe
- README.txt or README.md
- This manual (PDF recommended for distribution packages)

4-2. Python source version (for development / review)

- Prepare Python 3.11 or a nearby compatible version.
- Install pandas and openpyxl if needed.
- Run CS2_MOD_Integrated_GUI.py from the project folder.

```
pip install pandas openpyxl
python CS2_MOD_Integrated_GUI.py
```

4-3. Helpful notes for GitHub distribution

- Put the ZIP package on Releases and include the ZIP hash in the README or release notes.
- State clearly that the official EXE distribution source is the GitHub Releases page.
- Show the source location, updated date, target version, and author name on the cover or in the README.
- Add a short note about Windows Defender / SmartScreen behavior.

5. Screen guide

Start with the numbered screenshot so you can quickly understand which parts to check.

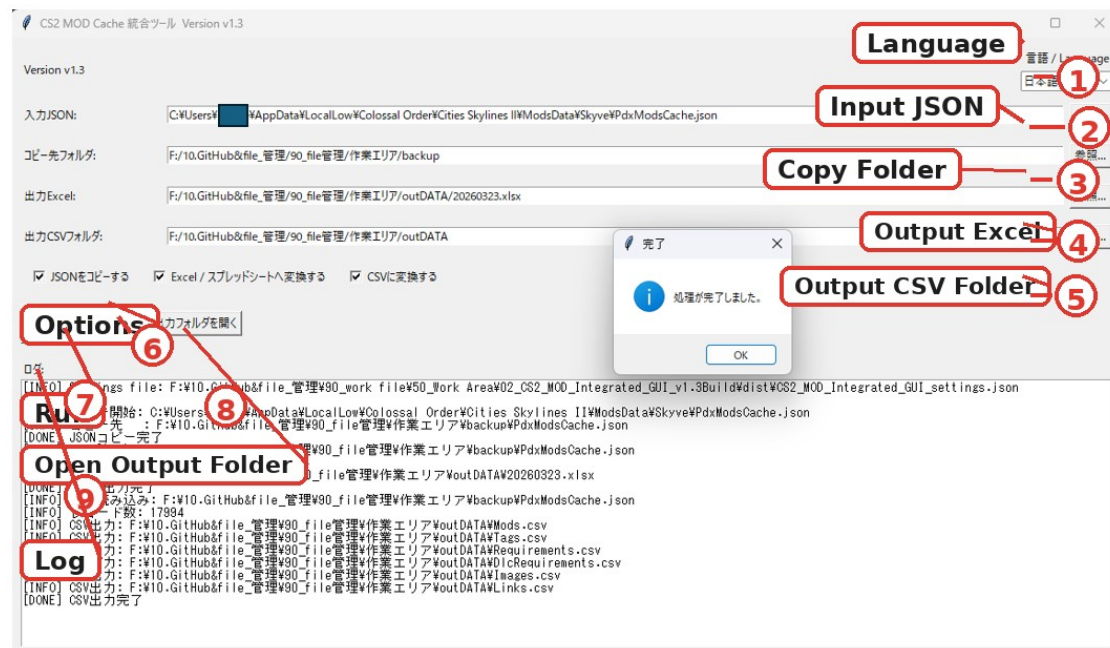


Figure 3. Names of the main screen areas

Note: The original data is managed on the Skyve side and may be confirmed from a screen like the example below.

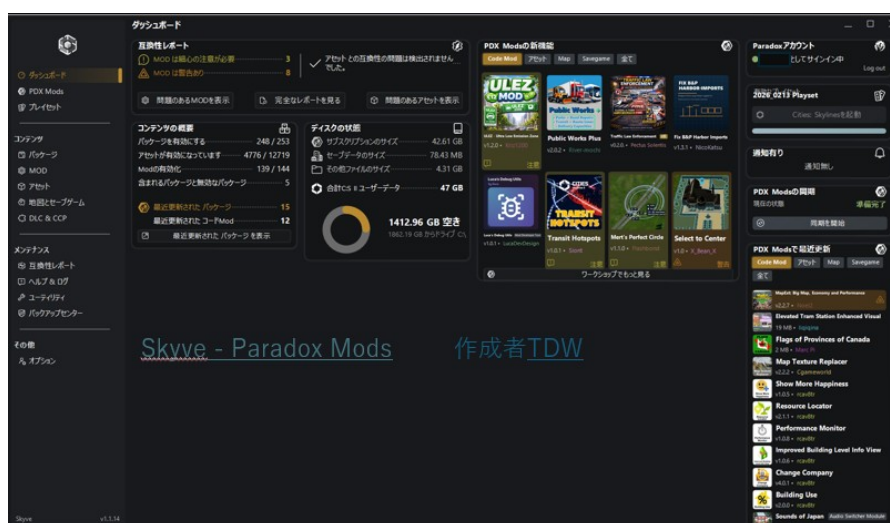


Figure 4. Example screen on the Skyve side

6. Basic workflow

Step 1: Start the tool

Previously saved settings may be restored automatically. On first launch, the fields may be blank or filled with defaults.

Step 2: Check Input JSON

Confirm that Input JSON points to PdxModsCache.json. If not, use Browse to select the correct file.

Step 3: Choose output destinations

Specify the backup folder, Excel output path, and CSV folder. A dedicated working folder is recommended.

Step 4: Select what to run

Use JSON copy only for a first backup test. Add Excel when you want browsable sheets, and add CSV when you want data for Access or Python workflows.

Step 5: Run

Press Run and watch the log area. A completion dialog usually means the process finished successfully.

Step 6: Verify outputs

Use Open Output Folder and make sure the expected files were created.

Recommended first test

- Run JSON copy first and confirm that a backup file is created.
- Next, add Excel export and check sheets such as Mods, Tags, and Requirements.
- Finally, add CSV export and use the files as material for Access or Python integration.

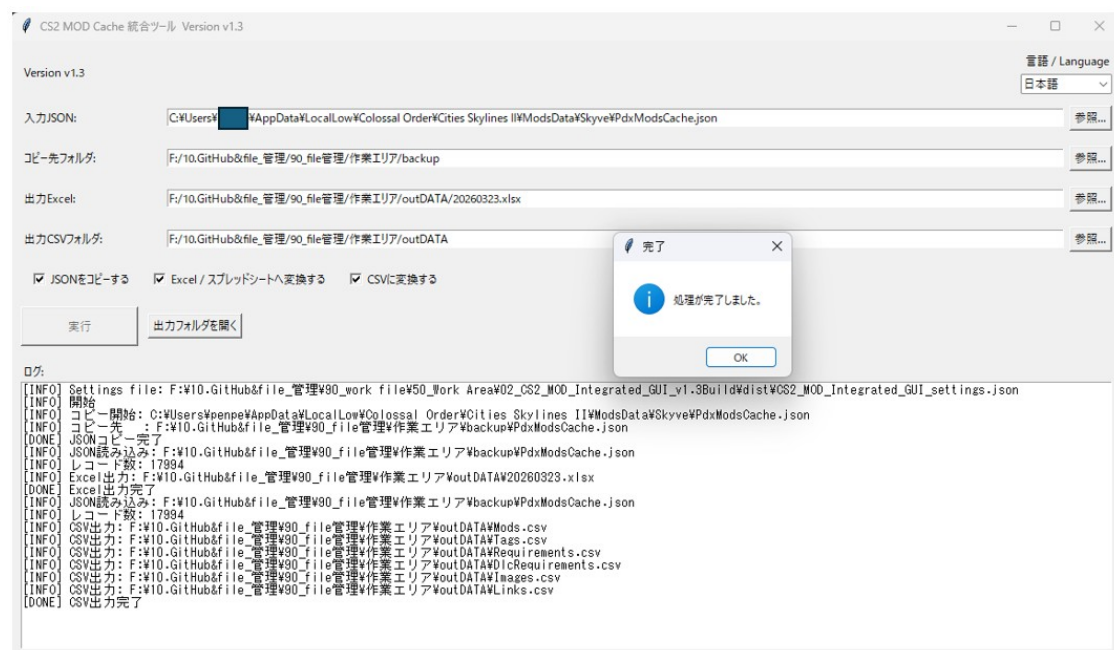


Figure 5. Example of completion message and log area

7. Output files

Output	Description	Typical use
Copied JSON	Backup copy of the original PdxModsCache.json	Safe archival copy before processing
Excel workbook (.xlsx)	Normalized workbook with multiple sheets	Browsing and manual review
CSV files	Separated tables exported as CSV	Access, Python, and data processing workflows
settings.json	Saved UI state such as paths and language	Restore the previous session

8. How the processing works

- JSON copy: copies the input JSON file to the selected backup folder.
- Excel export: normalizes the JSON structure and saves it as a multi-sheet .xlsx file.
- CSV export: writes almost the same logical data as separate CSV files.
- Settings save: stores input paths, output paths, language, and checkbox states in settings.json.

9. Preparing the project for GitHub distribution

- Show author, version, updated date, and distribution URL on the cover or in the README.
- Keep the Releases description concise: a few lines explaining what the tool does are enough.
- Include one or two screenshots so users can understand the input JSON and the expected outputs.
- Putting the EXE, README, and manual inside the ZIP package makes the distribution easier to use.

10. Troubleshooting

When something goes wrong, first check these three points in order: the log area, the Input JSON path, and the actual state of the output destination.

Symptom	Check point	Action
The tool does not start	EXE blocked by Windows / SmartScreen	Check the download source, verify the hash, then allow execution if it matches the official release.
Input JSON cannot be found	Wrong path or moved file	Open Skyve, confirm the real storage path, and select the file again with Browse.
Excel file is not created	Output path points to a missing or protected folder	Choose a writable folder and try again.
CSV files are not created	CSV folder path is invalid or unavailable	Create the folder manually first, then rerun.
Nothing seems to happen	Checkboxes are all off	Make sure at least one processing option is checked.
The process stops halfway	Another app is locking the file	Close Excel or any viewer using the target file, then rerun.
Restored settings look wrong	settings.json contains old values	Delete or reset settings.json and start again with fresh paths.

11. Example text for the distribution page

This is a short example that can be adapted for the body of a GitHub Releases page.

CS2 PdxModsCache Integrated Tool v1.3

This tool copies PdxModsCache.json, exports the content to Excel, and also generates CSV files.

It is intended for users who want to organize Cities: Skylines II MOD information managed through Skyve.

Please download the ZIP package from this Releases page and check the published hash value before running the EXE.

12. Key takeaways

- Adding author name, distribution URL, and target version to the cover makes the package easier to trust and understand.
- The EXE version should be the main path for general users, with the Python source version offered as supplemental information.
- Numbered screenshots and arrows reduce confusion for beginners.
- Troubleshooting is most practical when written as symptom → check point → action.